

In the Garden God Made

Unit 1 · Pillar 1: Design · Lavender, for calm and the senses



I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works.

Psalm 139:14

WEEK AT A GLANCE

- MONDAY** Read “Meet the Family” – the Eden family's homestead; meet lavender's calm.
- TUESDAY** Lavender discovery – smell, look, sketch the spike
- WEDNESDAY** Brew lavender tea – measure, steep, taste
- THURSDAY** Roman baths – draw lavender by Roman arches
- FRIDAY** Explore the living garden; wrap up the week together

Subjects woven this week: Bible · Science ·
ELA · Math · Art · History · Geography · Latin ·
Health · Character

AROUND THE TABLE

Lavender helps you feel calm, but God made your body to rest on its own. What does your body feel like when it is ready to sleep?

KITCHEN LAB - SUPPLIES NEEDED

- Dried lavender buds
- Hot water
- Mug
- Honey
- Cloth square + tie



Lavender

Lavandula angustifolia

Read-Aloud & Discussion

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Lavender

Foundations - Calm & Senses

STORY ORIENTATION

This week we begin our whole year with a story. Read "Meet the Family" aloud together, and meet the Eden family: Vovó and PopPop on their Tennessee homestead, Levi and Ruthie, big-hearted Manny, gentle Evie, fiery little Gracie, and Bear, the goofy dog who knocks something over every week. All year this family will learn the way we will, at the kitchen table and out in the garden, where God has already tucked everything our bodies need. Our whole first unit, In the Garden God Made, we slow down to wonder at two of His gifts: the garden bursting with life, and the wonderful body He gave you. Our herb this week is lavender, a calm, sweet-smelling flower people have used to help tired bodies rest for hundreds of years. As your child listens, notice how Vovó pays attention, to people, to plants, to the smallest things, the very way we will learn all year. Wonder together: what might God want to teach us this year about the wonderful bodies He made?

KEY CONCEPT

God gave you a body that needs rest, and gave lavender a calm scent to quiet it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. Which of the Eden family would you most like to meet, and why?
2. Vovó calls the garden and the table "the whole school" – what will we learn there?
3. I wonder – God made every part of you on purpose; which part makes you curious?

MEMORY VERSE

I am fearfully and wonderfully made; wonderful are Your works.

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender is soft and deep
Purple flowers calm the day
It will rock us off to sleep
Breathe in slow and drift away*

Today's threads: Bible • Language Arts • Character

TEACHER NOTES

LITTLE SPROUTS

Let them smell the dried buds, then a fresh sprig, and say which is stronger. Tuck one behind an ear. Just smell and compare.

OLDER SPROUTS

Have them rub a lavender bud and a fresh sprig, then explain why drying makes the scent stronger.

TODAY'S WORD:

SENSES – the ways our body takes in the world: sight, smell, hearing, taste, and touch.

How woven –

Bible: the memory verse, Psalm 139:14, that you are wonderfully made;

Language Arts: your child meets the Eden family and learns to name them and retell who is who;

Character: attention – like Vovó, we learn to notice people and small things with care. Lavender greets us first through the senses, with its calm, sweet smell – a gift to a body God made to know His world.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

ELA (Reading) • R3 – retell "Meet the Family," who is who

ELA (Speaking) • R2 – answer the week's discussion questions

Discovery

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Foundations - Calm & Senses

DISCOVERY LESSON

Breathe in slowly, the way a naturalist would: that clean calm is lavender. Set a few dried buds in your child's palm. Look first: lavender climbs on tall, slender spikes, and every tiny flower is purple. Roll one bud between two fingers and breathe in – that soft, clean scent is its gift. Then feel the narrow, gray-green leaves, a little dry and rough, the way plants of sunny, rocky hillsides often are. Ask your child to tell back what each sense found, in their own words; there is no wrong answer, only careful looking. The same God who folded that scent into so small a flower made the very nose that breathes it in.

CORE QUESTION:

What does your nose notice first when you rub a lavender bud?

TEACHING PROGRESSION

1. Look: find lavender's purple spikes and gray-green leaves.
 2. Rub: roll one bud between two fingers.
 3. Smell: breathe in slow – does your body settle?
 4. Name it: lavender's scent supports calm and rest.
 5. Say today's word, RELAXING – helps the body let go and rest.
- Little Sprouts: just smell, and say soft or strong.
Older Sprouts: tell why lavender helps a tired body rest.

NATURE NOTEBOOK

Draw a lavender spike; label the purple flowers and stem.
Say it: *Lavandula angustifolia* – from lavare, 'to wash'.

LAVENDER CHANT

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Breathe in slow and drift away*

Today's threads: Science • Art • Language Arts • Latin

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

RELAXING – eases tension so the body can settle and rest.

How woven –

Science: observing scent, color, and spike shape;

Art: a labeled sketch in the Nature Notebook;

Language Arts: a new vocabulary word;

Latin: its name, *Lavandula*.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – observe lavender's purple spikes and calming scent

Science-R3 – find where lavender hides its calming scent, in the flowers

Art-R3 – sketch and label a lavender spike

Latin-R2 – learn the Latin name, *Lavandula angustifolia*

Kitchen Lab

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Foundations - Calm & Senses

KITCHEN LAB

Today is our first Kitchen Lab, and we are making lavender tea. Grown-ups call a tea made from flowers or leaves an infusion – it just means soaking them in hot water to draw out scent and flavor. So 'infusion' and 'tea' are the same thing! We will also tie a few dried buds into a little cloth sachet. One prep, made and enjoyed today.

TEACHING NOTE

A same-day lab: brew and taste today; we never save it. Hot water is hot – a grown-up always pours it and lets the tea cool before your child sips.

STEP-BY-STEP

1. Measure 1 tsp of dried lavender buds into a mug.
 2. Pour 8 oz of hot water over the buds.
 3. Cover and steep 5 minutes – count them together.
 4. Strain out the buds.
 5. Stir in a little honey if you like; cool, then taste.
 6. For the sachet: spoon dried buds onto a cloth square and tie it shut.
- Little Sprouts: measure the lavender buds and breathe in their calm smell before the water is poured.
- Older Sprouts: watch the clock for the 5-minute steep, then strain out the buds by yourself.

BEAR MOMENT

Bear says: A little lavender goes far! We smell and touch the dried buds, but lavender essential oil is very strong – never taste it.

LAVENDER CHANT

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Breathe in slow and drift away*

Today's threads: Science · Math · Health

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

SACHET – a small cloth bag of dried herbs that scents the air.

How woven –

Science: hot water draws the scent and flavor out of the dried buds;

Math: measure 1 teaspoon and count 5 steep-minutes;

Health: warm tea and slow breathing help the body rest.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science-R2 – watch hot water draw lavender's scent into an infusion

Math-R3 – measure 1 tsp and time a 5-minute steep

Health-R2 – a grown-up pours the hot water

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "sachet"

History & Art

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Foundations - Calm & Senses

HISTORY LESSON

In ancient Rome, the public baths steamed with the fresh scent of lavender. The Romans loved to be clean, and they tucked lavender into their bathwater and even their laundry, so their skin and clothes carried its fresh, calming scent. They loved it so much that the plant's very name remembers it: 'lavender' is said to come from the Latin word lavare, which means 'to wash.' Every time we say its name, we speak a little Latin from two thousand years ago! Long before anyone could explain why a calming, cleansing plant was good for tired bodies, the gift was already growing on the sunny hillsides, waiting in the garden for the Romans.

CREATION CARE TIMELINE

God made every plant on Creation's third day (Genesis 1:11-12). About 2,000 years ago the Romans pinned lavender to history, scenting their baths and laundry with it; its name is traditionally traced to lavare – 'to wash.'

ART ACTIVITY

1. Draw three tall lavender stems rising up your page.
2. Climb each stem with rows of tiny purple flowers.
3. Color the slender leaves a soft gray-green.
4. Behind them, add Roman arches and columns.
5. Title it 'Lavender in Rome' and sign your name.

ON THE MAP

Find the Mediterranean Sea and Italy on the map. Lavender loves the warm, sunny, rocky hills of this seaside land.

LAVENDER CHANT

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Today's threads: History • Geography • Art • Language Arts

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

LAVARE – the Latin word for 'to wash,' the root of the name 'lavender.'

How woven –

History: the Romans and their scented baths; Geography: finding the Mediterranean and Italy;

Art: a Roman-arch lavender drawing;

Language Arts: hearing and retelling the history.

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

History-R2 – retell how the Romans scented their baths with lavender

Geography-R2 – locate the Mediterranean Sea and Italy

Art-R3 – draw lavender among Roman arches

ELA (Vocabulary)-R2 – learn the term "lavare"

Garden & Review

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Foundations - Calm & Senses

GARDEN ACTIVITY

A GARDEN IS ALIVE. Stand still in a garden for a minute and you will find it is not still at all. God did not fill His garden with dead, unmoving things; He packed it with life, from the tallest sunflower to the tiniest ant. Leaves drink sunlight, worms tunnel the soil, bees hum flower to flower, and roots sip water underground. This first unit we slow down to wonder at all that God-made busyness.

DO: Visit a garden, yard, or windowsill plant and find three living things, maybe a leaf, a bug, and a worm. Look closely, then tell each one out loud, "You are alive!"

Little Sprouts: find one living thing and name it.

Older Sprouts: draw your three and tell what each was doing.

NEXT WEEK

Next week: chamomile – a tiny daisy flower that brings calm and grows so easily.

WEEK REVIEW

1. How does lavender's calm scent help the body God gave you?
2. You smelled, brewed, and grew lavender. Which did you like best?
3. Lavender made its scent before anyone knew why. What does that make you wonder about God?
4. This week you found the garden full of life. What living thing will you thank God for?

MEMORY VERSE RECAP

Recite Psalm 139:14

LAVENDER CHANT

*Lavender is soft and deep
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Breathe in slow and drift away*

"God gave us the scent of rest so we would remember to be still." –

Vovó

Today's threads: Science · Language Arts · Bible

TEACHER NOTES

TODAY'S WORD:

ALIVE – living and growing, not still or dead.

How woven –

Science: hunting for the living things in the garden;

Language Arts: retelling the week's review questions;

Bible: reciting Psalm 139:14 with Vovó's blessing.

WORKS CITED

Grieve, A Modern Herbal (1931), 'Lavenders' ·

POWO, *Lavandula angustifolia* (Kew) ·

NCCIH, *Lavender* · NASB

Psalm 139:13–14

FURTHER READING

Roots, Shoots, Buckets &

Boots – Sharon Lovejoy (family read)

LEARNING BENCHMARKS

Science·R2 – find that a garden is full of living things

Math·R2 – count the living things you find

ELA·R2 – answer the week's four review questions